

(right) will defend his flyweight title for the fourth time when he faces Japan's Kai Asakura at the T-Mobile Arena in the main event of UFC 310.

Pantoja's most recent outing was an astounding success, as he secured a first-round knockout win over Australia's Steve Erceg at UFC 305 in May earlier this year.

On the other hand, the Japanese MMA star has won 21 of 25 fights in his career so far and now has the chance to become his country's first champion against one of the greatest flyweights in history.

Meanwhile, the supposed welterweight title bout had to be scrapped after Belal Muhammad suffered a bone infection in his foot in October.

Muhammad shared the news in a social media post. "Caught a bone infection in my foot," Muhammad wrote. "Had to put a PICC (peripherally inserted central catheter) line in my arm for IV antibiotics for the next six weeks with no physical activity," he added.

Muhammad, aka Remember the Name, clinched the title with a unanimous decision victory over Leon Edwards at UFC 304 in July. He is unbeaten in his past 11 bouts and hasn't faced a defeat in nearly six years. Meanwhile, Rakhmonov earned his first UFC championship opportunity with a second-round submission of Stephen Thompson at UFC 296 this past December. Nomad, as his moniker goes, has finished all 18 of the opponents he's faced as a professional.

Welterweight number seven Ian Machado Garry was roped in as the replacement, and the bout will now be a co-main event instead of a title fight.

UFC 310 will be the final numbered event of the year. The series will resume next year on January 19 with UFC 311, for which the cards have yet to be announced.

